

Chelsea Contractor Brief, Friday 15 May 2026

Internal working doc. Email-safe one-pager separate.

The job in one line

Cover for Harrison on site at RHS Chelsea Flower Show, Friday 15 May 2026. Two days to judging. Phone capture only. Hero is Michael Buck's judging-eve walk-through. Stories bank for Harrison to edit and post remotely from Copenhagen.

Why this matters

Chelsea is the content centrepiece of the Creepers year. Four gardens supplied: Boodles (Catherine MacDonald), A Seed In Time (Baz Grainger, Landform), Addleshaw Goddard "Flourish in the City" (Joe and Laura Carey), Range Rover installation. Friday sits between Wednesday (Harrison on site) and Monday press day (Harrison back in). The Friday capture has to land cleanly or the week's content sequence breaks.

Where Harrison is

- Tue 12 May: Harrison in London
- Wed 13 May: Harrison on site at Chelsea, build day
- Thu 14 May: Harrison Copenhagen, AM flight
- Fri 15 May: contractor covers, Harrison on WhatsApp for sign-off all day
- Sat 16 / Sun 17 May: dark days, Harrison handles remote
- Mon 18 May: press day, embargo lifts, Harrison back on site

Schedule for the day

Time	What
17:00 Thu 14 May	Anna Blake brief lands. Harrison forwards. No shoot proceeds without it.
07:30 Fri 15 May	Contractor at gate. Accreditation collected via Anna.
08:00 to 17:30	On-plot capture across four gardens. Stories drip-fed to Harrison via WhatsApp for approval.
18:00 to 18:30	Final stories, end-of-day mood. Designers stepping back.
19:00	File transfer dropped in shared folder.
10h cap	If runs over, flag in real time.

Brief from Anna Blake (placeholder)

[TO BE FORWARDED. Expected by 17:00 Thu 14 May. Standing rule from 5 May stand-down: no shoot day proceeds without Anna's brief in writing. If 17:00 passes with no brief, Harrison chases Anna directly. Contractor does not travel without confirmed access.]

Shot list

Hero, the post

Michael Buck judging-eve walk-through. ~3 to 5 min rolling clip, phone in landscape. Quiet, observational. Him looking at the work, touching specimens, in conversation with designers. This becomes

the Friday evening or Saturday morning Nursery IG post. Caption locked: "*Michael Buck on the ground at Chelsea. Two days to judging.*"

If turnaround is tight, hold for Saturday morning rather than rushing the edit.

People moments (priority)

- Designers in conversation, tight crops. Faces, hands. No audio needed.
- Team in gear, working. Michael with the crew.
- Designers stepping back to look at finished plots, end of day.
- Catherine MacDonald, Baz Grainger, Carey duo: tight portraits if naturally available. Do not pose them.

B-roll, build-week prep

- Final touches: hands on details, tools being placed down, last specimens being set.
- Scaffolding coming down.
- Materials moving, deliveries, crates.
- Quiet hands, single specimens (tight crops, not compositional).
- A designer pausing.
- 10 to 15 seconds at each plot of one quiet moment, for post-show use.

Stories pace

4 to 6 across the day, spread out. Not blasted in one go. Restraint is the point. Capture more than that, just don't post more than that.

What NOT to capture for public release

- No wide garden compositions
- No reveals of finished gardens
- No anything that telegraphs the design intent
- No BBC cameras, crew, or branding visible in shots intended for posting

Embargo rules

BBC have exclusive on all garden content until press day, Monday 18 May. Embargo violations damage Creepers' RHS relationships permanently. This is not a soft rule.

Safe to post (with Harrison sign-off)

- Tight people moments
- Hands, tools, specimens at close crop, not compositional
- Build-process context, scaffolding, materials moving
- "Two days to judging" energy with no garden reveal in frame

Capture only, do not post

- Full garden compositions
- Wide plot shots
- Anything showing the finished design
- BBC cameras working, crew, or branding (no tagging, no reference under accreditation terms)

Sign-off rule

Nothing goes to feed or stories without Harrison's explicit approval. Workflow: contractor captures, sends frames or clips to Harrison via WhatsApp, Harrison approves, Harrison posts. Contractor does not post from Creepers accounts directly.

Contact tree at the showgrounds

Name	Role	When to use
Anna Blake	Creepers Office Manager	Logistics, accreditation, access issues
Michael Buck	Creepers Head of Horticulture	Hero subject Friday. The face.
Rob Ryall	Creepers Owner / MD	Escalation only
Catherine MacDonald	Boodles designer, Landform	Permission on Boodles plot
Baz Grainger	A Seed In Time, Landform	Permission on his plot
Joe and Laura Carey	Addleshaw Goddard designers	Permission on their plot
Harrison Living	WhatsApp +44 7761 835304	Real-time approvals all day, Copenhagen GMT+2

Post-production handoff to Harrison

- End-of-day file transfer: Google Drive shared folder. Link sent Thursday evening.
- Naming: 2026-05-15_chelsea_[plot]_[descriptor].mov (plots: boodles, seedintime, addleshaw, rangerover, general)
- Phone capture, ProRes if her device supports it, else default H.264 1080p or higher.
- Harrison edits Michael Buck reel in CapCut for Fri PM or Sat AM post.
- Stories Harrison posts in real time from contractor's drops.

Rate and invoice terms

- **£400/day or £40/hr, cap 10 hours.**
- **7-day NET** from invoice date.
- Invoice to: Harrison Living, HWL Studio. Email: harrison.living@gmail.com.
- Day rate covers: on-ground capture, real-time WhatsApp drops, end-of-day file transfer, one revision round on selected stills within 48h.
- Travel and incidentals not included. Flag in advance.

Margin (internal only)

- Creepers rate to Harrison: £70/hr
- Contractor rate: £40/hr or £400/day
- Margin: ~£30/hr, ~£300/day at 10h cap
- £40/hr locked. Hold unless contractor raises a specific reason (equipment hire, extended day).

Reference style

Creepers Chelsea drone reel: [instagram.com/reel/DW7Gw9_DQym](https://www.instagram.com/reel/DW7Gw9_DQym)

Tone: premium horticulture, documentary, quiet expertise. Slow shots. No fast cuts. No music-led pacing. People and process over plants. Director-of-photography-grade visuals from a phone.

Failure modes to watch

- Anna brief doesn't land by 17:00 Thursday. Harrison chases. Contractor does not travel without it.
- Contractor posts something to Creepers feed directly. Sign-off rule should prevent this, reinforce in email.
- Garden reveal in frame on a story. Approval gate catches it.
- BBC crew visible in a posted story. Approval gate catches it.
- Day runs past 10h. Flag in real time, do not assume overtime authorised.